NORTHERN GULF PORTS AUTHORITY · DIGITAL PORT PROGRAMME

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL · NGPA/T/2026/021

Port Community System: Web Platform, Messaging Hub and Integration Services

Port of Al-Noor and its inland container depot

SAMPLE · FICTIONAL

Tender reference	**NGPA/T/2026/021**
Procedure	Open tender · two-envelope (technical / financial)
Date of issue	2 November 2026
Bid closing date	15 January 2027, 12:00 local time
Contact	Tender Committee Secretariat · tenders@ngpa.example

SAMPLE DOCUMENT. This tender, the authority and the port are fictional. The document was created to test procurement-evaluation software.

1. Background

1.1 The Port of Al-Noor exchanges most trade documents with shipping agents, freight forwarders, hauliers and the General Customs Directorate by e-mail, fax and paper. Container release requires on average 7 separate submissions and 2.3 days.

1.2 The Northern Gulf Ports Authority (NGPA) seeks a **Port Community System (PCS)**: a single web platform and messaging hub through which the port community submits, tracks and exchanges cargo, vessel and release information.

2. Scope

2.1 Web portal for port community users (shipping agents, forwarders, hauliers, customs brokers), with company onboarding, user management and role-based access.

2.2 Messaging hub converting between UN/EDIFACT (BAPLIE, COPARN, CODECO, CUSCAR, CUSRES), XML and JSON/REST, with guaranteed delivery and message tracking.

2.3 Integration with the Terminal Operating Systems of T1 and T2, the Customs Risk Management System, the Maritime Single Window and the Authority's ERP for port dues invoicing.

2.4 Vehicle booking system for truck appointments at the terminal gates, with SMS and app notifications in Arabic and English.

2.5 Implementation, data migration of 3 years of vessel-call history, training, and 3 years of support and maintenance after go-live.

3. Requirements

3.1 The PCS, including all databases, integration components, monitoring and backups, shall be hosted in the Authority's data centres in the State. No component may depend on a public cloud service. MANDATORY

3.2 Availability of 99.8 % per calendar month for the portal and the messaging hub, measured at the Authority's monitoring system. MANDATORY

3.3 Capacity for 4,500 registered users, 600 concurrent users and 250,000 messages per day with a 95th-percentile processing time below 5 seconds. MANDATORY

3.4 User authentication with multi-factor authentication for all external users; integration with the Authority's Active Directory for internal users. MANDATORY

3.5 Full user interface in Arabic and English, including right-to-left layout. MANDATORY

3.6 Open REST APIs documented in OpenAPI 3 for community systems, with a sandbox environment. IMPORTANT

3.7 Dashboards of container dwell time, gate waiting times and release lead times. IMPORTANT

3.8 Mobile application for hauliers (Android and iOS) for truck appointments. DESIRABLE

3.9 Compliance with the Authority's IT Security & Data Residency Standard (CITS-2026). MANDATORY

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4. Implementation and support

4.1 Go-live of the portal, messaging hub and customs/TOS integrations within **10 months** of contract signature; the vehicle booking system within 12 months. MANDATORY

4.2 Training of 30 Authority staff (administrators and helpdesk) and community onboarding sessions for at least 150 companies.

4.3 Support 24/7 for severity-1 incidents with a 1-hour response and 4-hour restoration; 3 years of support and maintenance priced per year. MANDATORY

5. Evaluation

5.1 Technical evaluation (70 %): functional coverage 30, architecture and security 25, integration experience 20, implementation plan 15, support 10. Minimum technical score 70.

5.2 Financial evaluation (30 %): evaluated price = implementation + 3 years of support and maintenance.

5.3 Bid validity 120 days; bid security USD 50,000 issued or confirmed by a bank licensed in the State.

Chair, Tender Committee
Northern Gulf Ports Authority

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